



Unit 5

My Country

5.1

ORAL COMMUNICATION

The students will be able to use language verbally to:

- i. Use polite expressions to seek attention
- ii. Make polite requests for personal reasons

Dialogue: Homework

- Meena:** Excuse me, teacher.
Can I talk to you for a minute?
- Teacher:** Sure. What is it?
- Meena:** I was not able to complete
my homework as my mother was ill.
- Teacher:** I'm sorry to hear that. What happened?
- Meena:** She had diarrhoea and vomiting.
- Teacher:** Is she all right now?
- Meena:** Yes, we gave her ORS and that helped her.
- Teacher:** I'm glad to hear that you gave her ORS.
- Meena:** Can I please submit my work tomorrow?
- Teacher:** Sure, you can. You always do your work on time.
- Meena:** Thank you, teacher.



Note for Teachers: Divide the students into pairs and ask them to roleplay the above dialogue. First one of them acts as Meena and the other as the teacher. Then they reverse the roles and again repeat the dialogues. After they have done this, change their partners. Ask the new pairs to play other roles using other reasons but the same dialogue.

The students will further practise reading techniques learnt in earlier units and learn some new ones, including:

- i. *Generate questions to understand the text*
- ii. *Describe a series of events*
- iii. *Use pre-reading strategies to predict the content/vocabulary of a text from picture and title etc. by using prior knowledge*

Pre-reading

Teacher's Guidelines: Ask the students the following questions:

- ☐ Can you remember a time when something went wrong?
- ☐ What did you do?
- ☐ What did your family do?
- ☐ Is there something else that you or your family could have done?
- ☐ Do you think floods are a blessing? Why? Why not?

Reading Text

Floods, blessing in disguise

The floods during the monsoon season in 2010 affected people in all the four provinces of Pakistan. Thousands of people lost their family members, relatives or friends. Thousands, in fact hundreds of thousands, became homeless. Huge areas of land were flooded and the crops were destroyed. People lost cattle, chickens, and other sources of income. But, people had faith in Allah. They did not give up hope. Soon, things started to change for the better for many of them.

Note for Teachers: Follow the reading guidelines mentioned in the initial pages. Ask students to do exercise 1 while reading the text.



The floods were a blessing in disguise for Haseena Mai. She was a widow and a mother of three children. Before the floods, she worked as a maid in people's houses to feed her children. During the worst floods in Pakistan's history, Haseena lost her house and her job. Then, one of the non-governmental organisations (NGO) started work for the flood affected people gave her 50 hens with feed for three months. By the time the water receded, the hens were big enough to lay eggs. Haseena sold the eggs, then she bought more feed and also more hens. She now owns a small poultry farm and earns around Rs. 30,000 each month. Haseena has become an inspiration for the men and women in her area.

Haseena is not alone in her success. There are others also who did not give up when faced with the disaster. They kept up their hopes and fought for a better life even when everything was lost. One such person was Rana Mumtaz Ali. Several acres of his agricultural land were lying barren because of salinity before the floods. However, when the floods came they brought fertile soil to his land. The result was that around 100 acres of his once barren land became very fertile. In the season after the floods this land produced 1,760 kilogrammes of wheat per acre.

5.2 READING

According to Rana Mumtaz Ali, 'The crop was so thick that even a snake could not find place to go in.'

According to another farmer, Muhammad Sharif, an area of around 15 kilometres of infertile land in his region could now be cultivated. Moreover, in areas where the wheat production per acre before the floods was around 2,200 kilogrammes (kgs), it increased to 2,600 kgs per acre after the floods.

Floodwater lakes also provided livelihood to people. For example, one of the lakes that was naturally formed by the floods in one of the affected areas had plenty of fishes. One of the persons living in this area, Jamshed, said that he could easily catch up to 15 kilogrammes of fish from that lake and sell it in the market. He said that, for him, the lake had proved to be a blessing. In fact, the number of such fisheries increased by about thirty percent after the floods.

While Reading

Exercise 1: In this text, find out how many people benefitted from the floods? Write down their names.

Post Reading

Exercise 2: In the following sentences the meaning of some of the words used in the text is given. Read the text and find out which word in the text matches the meaning. The first one has been done as an example.

- i. In paragraph 1, the word cattle means animals kept on farms for their milk and meat.
- ii. In paragraph 2, the word _____ means something that brings happiness.



5.2 READING

- iii. In paragraph 2, the word _____ means something different from normal.
- iv. In paragraph 2, the word _____ means a woman whose husband has died.
- v. In paragraph 2, the word _____ means a woman who works as a servant in a house.
- vi. In paragraph 2, the word _____ means food for birds/ animals.
- vii. In paragraph 2, the word _____ means moved back.
- viii. In paragraph 2, the word _____ means a person whom others want to follow.
- ix. In paragraph 3, the word _____ means an event that causes great damage or loss of life.
- x. In paragraph 3, the word _____ means land on which crop does not grow.
- xi. In paragraph 3, the word _____ means too much salt in the land.
- xii. In paragraph 3, the word _____ means land that can produce good crops.
- xiii. In paragraph 4, the word _____ means used for growing crops
- xiv. In paragraph 5, the word _____ means source of income.

Exercise 3: The following statements can be found in **paragraphs one and two** of the reading text above. Read the text and first complete all the questions. Remember, many words are the same in both the question and the answer.

After you have done the questions write the answers. The first one has been done for you.

- i. **Who was** affected by the monsoon floods in 2010?
People in all the four provinces of Pakistan were *affected by the monsoon floods in 2010.*
- ii. How many people _____?
_____ people became homeless.
- iii. What _____ did the people lose?
The people lost their _____.
- iv. What did Haseena Mai do _____?
Haseena Mai _____ in people's houses before the floods.
- v. What did _____ (NGO) give her?
One of the non-governmental organisations (NGO) gave her _____.
- vi. What did she do _____?
After selling the eggs, she _____.

Note for Teachers: Before asking students to do exercise 3, explain to them how some of the information in the questions helps in completing the answers and how some of the information in the answers helps in completing the questions. In the examples above, the words in italics are repeated in both the question and the answer. However, the answers **(in bold print)** can be found by reading the text. Use other everyday use questions to explain this point on the blackboard.



Exercise 4: The following answers are given in **paragraph three**. Read the text and write the questions to which these answers are given. Remember to use the question mark at the end of the question. The first one has been done for you.

- i. Why was Rana Mumtaz Ali's land lying barren?

Rana Mumtaz Ali's land was lying barren because of salinity.

- ii. _____

The floods brought fertile soil to his land.

- iii. _____

After the floods his land produced 1,760 kilogrammes of wheat per acre.

- iv. _____

The crop was so thick that even a snake could not find place to go in.

Note for Teachers: Give some simple statements like 'My mother cooks food every day' and ask them to frame a question for it. Respect the rules with the help of exercise 3.

Exercise 5: Now read paragraphs four and five and write three questions and their answers in your notebook.

Exercise 6:

- i. How were the people affected by the floods?
- ii. Why did people not give up hope?
- iii. How were the floods a blessing in disguise for Haseena Mai?
- iv. How has Haseena Mai become an inspiration for the people in her area?
- v. How did Rana Mumtaz Ali benefit from the flood?
- vi. How did Muhammad Sharif benefit from the flood?
- vii. How did the floods affect Jamshed?



5.3 WRITING

The writing tasks in this unit should enable students to:

- i. Use conventions of letter writing: address, date, salutation, body, closing, to write a letter
- ii. Write a short reply to a short informal letter from friends and family members



5.3 WRITING

Exercise 1: Read the following two letters and fill in the blanks. The information missing in one letter can be found in the other letter.

N 36, Block Z,
Pak Society,
Karachi.

15 March 2015.

Dear Maria,

I hope you and your _____ are quite well. I received your letter two weeks ago but I was not able to reply because I was having my _____ tests. I was able to do all my _____ well because I had studied _____. I hope I get good _____. I am now free so I thought of writing you a letter.

You remember I told you that one of my _____ will be getting married in _____. Well, the wedding will be held on the 14th of October but we will go to Sukkur on the _____. The reason is that Sukkur is far from _____ and it will take us one whole _____ to reach it. Another reason is that we want to participate in the mehndi _____ which will be on the 12th of October.

When will your half-yearly _____ begin? I am sure that you will do well because you are a hardworking _____. I hope that you will go to Murree this year to see the _____ during the _____ vacations.

How are your _____? Please give my regards to them. Also give my _____ to your brother and Bhabhi. Give my love to your cute little _____. I hope you will reply to this letter soon.

Yours sincerely,

_____.

5.3 WRITING

House No. 94/ 2,
Chishtia Street,
Multan.

19 March 2015.

Dear Samina,

Thank you for your letter. By the grace of Allah, my family is fine. I hope that _____ and your family are quite well. I am glad to know that your bi-monthly _____ are over. I'm sure you did all your papers _____ because you had _____ hard. I'm sure you will get _____ marks.

Yes, I _____ you telling me that one of your cousins would be getting _____ in October? Although the wedding will be held on the _____ it is good that you are going to Sukkur on the 11th of October. You are right, _____ is quite far from Karachi and it will take you one _____ day to reach it. Also, going early will give you a chance to participate in the _____ celebrations, which is the most enjoyable part of the wedding.

My _____ exams will begin on the 4th of December and finish on the 12th. I hope that I will do well because I don't think that I am a very _____ student. After the exams, I hope to go to _____ this year to see the snowfall during the winter _____.

My parents are fine and they send you their love and blessings. How are your parents? Please give them my _____. Also give my regards to both your sisters. My cute _____ niece has now started saying some words and we all love hearing her talk. Looking forward to hearing from you.

Yours _____,

Maria.

5.3 WRITING

Exercise 2: Following the above format, write a letter to your friend telling them about how you did in your annual exams and what your plans are for the summer holidays. Write the letter on a piece of paper.

Exercise 3: Exchange your letter with your partner, read the letter you receive and, on another piece of paper, write a reply to your friend. Give the paper on which you have written your reply to the person who wrote the letter.



Note for Teachers: The main purpose of exercise 1 is to show students how small informal letters are written. Once the students have completed the exercise, discuss the format of the letter with them. Tell them how the date and address is written, how the letter begins and ends, and about the three parts of the letter: introduction, body, and conclusion. Then ask them to do exercises 2 and 3.

In this section, the students will practice some of the grammar items learnt previously and learn some new ones, including:

- i. Agreement of pronouns with noun gender/ number
- ii. Adjectives of colour
- iii. Degrees of regular and irregular adjectives
- iv. use of conjunction 'because'

Pronouns

Exercise 1: Below are some facts about Kaleem, his sister Jamila, and his parents. Read these facts and write one paragraph about each one of them. The first line of each paragraph is given below. In all the following sentences use only the pronouns, not their names.

Kaleem	Jamila	Parents
ten years old	seven years old	love their children
class V	class II	father shopkeeper
good student	good at maths	mother teacher
liked by teachers	to be an engineer	work very hard
Plays with friends	sometimes plays with her brother	help children with homework
favourite game football	favourite hobby computer games	take good care of children

Example: Kaleem is ten years old. He studies in class V.

Kaleem has one sister. Her name _____

Kaleem has lovely parents. They _____

Exercise 2:

Mrs. Alvi was going shopping. She asked her family members if they wanted something. Here are the things they wanted: Azeem jacket, Seema frock, Habib mug, Nabeel pair of shoes, Faiza bunch of flowers, and Moomal bag. Mrs. Alvi wrote down a list, along with the colours, so that she would not forget.

Look at the pictures below and write down in complete sentences what each one wants. Write their names in an alphabetical order. Don't forget to write the colour of the items. Remember to use the article 'a'. The first one has been done for you.

1. Azeem wants a **blue jacket**.

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

6. _____



Note for Teachers: Before asking the class to do exercises 3 and 4, make them play a game with the degrees of adjectives. Quickly explain to them what an adjective is and what the degrees of adjectives are. Divide the class into three groups then tell them the rules of the game: 1) Each group will write as many adjectives as they can within the given time 2) group one will call out one adjective, then group two will call out its comparative degree and group three its superlative degree 3) then group two will call out one adjective group three the comparative and group one the superlative 4) this will be repeated with group three calling out the adjective, hence all groups, turn by turn will call out one adjective and the others will respond accordingly 5) if a group cannot give the correct answer the caller group will get the chance to answer it and if it cannot then the remaining group will be given a chance 6) for each correct answer the group will receive one point which will be noted on the blackboard by the teacher. The group with the most points will win the game.

After playing the game explain to the students that while some adjectives follow the 'er' and 'est' rule for the comparative and superlative degrees, others do not.

5.4 GRAMMAR

Exercise 3: Fill in the gaps in the given table with the correct word provided in the list below.

happy	least	beautiful	better	bad
more useful	early	most	less	
worse	earliest	more	happier	
most useful	best	most beautiful		

S. No.	Positive	Comparative	Superlative
1.	good	better	
2.	bad		worst
3.		earlier	
4.	many		
5.		lesser	
6.	useful		
7.			happiest
8.		more beautiful	

5.4 GRAMMAR

Exercise 4: Look at the table below to find out about the weight, height (4'7" means four feet and seven inches), marks obtained, and runs scored by each student. Then, select an adjective from those given below and use its superlative degree to complete the following sentences. Remember that 'the' is always used before a superlative degree. The first one has been done as an example.

Name	Weight	Height	Marks Obtained	Runs Scored
Arif Rahim	62 kg	4'8"	509	143
Bachal Allahyar	79 kg	4'4"	583	109
Latif Memon	74 kg	4'9"	533	179
Nasir Mureed	69 kg	4'2"	574	184
Peer Bakhsh	63 kg	4'5"	594	112

heavy light tall short many less high low

1. Bachal Allahyar is the heaviest boy in the class.
2. Peer Bakhsh got _____ marks in the class.
3. Bachal Allahyar scored _____ runs in the class match.
4. Nasir Mureed is _____ student in the class.
5. Arif Rahim got _____ marks in the class.
6. Nasir Mureed scored _____ runs in the class match.
7. Latif Memon is _____ student in the class.
8. Arif Rahim is _____ boy in the class.

Exercise 5: Rewrite the following sentences in the correct order. Remember to use the capital letters and full stops.

- i. late there jam school was because a I today traffic reached
- ii. she school sick my is friend from today because absent is
- iii. done happy their teacher students very work our all was because the had
- iv. stick man is cannot because white carrying old see he the a
- v. because homework his wanted salim he play finished to quickly
- vi. mother washing razia their sick and hameed dishes are is because the
- vii. win practising the to team match is because the want hard they

Exercise 6:

- (A) Write three sentences to tell your mother why you want to
- a) buy a new bag
 - b) visit your friend
 - c) go to bed early
- (B) Write three sentences to tell your mother why you don't want to
- a) play hockey
 - b) have dinner
 - c) go to your aunt's house



Vocabulary and Dictionary Skills

Exercise 1: Make as many words as you can with the word:

University



Exercise 2: Put the words in an alphabetical order.

Exercise 3: Use as many of these words as you can in your own sentences.



Our National Flag (Poem)

Nations are recognized by their flags,
They are displayed on houses, cars and bags.

The white in our flag represents minority,
And the green shows peace and prosperity.

The crescent symbolizes Islamic grace,
And the star indicates spiritual progress.

We should always keep our national flag high,
And be ready to sacrifice our life for it to fly.

(By Zunaira H. Gwadri)

Exercise 1: Draw a flag of Pakistan, colour it, and paste it on a stick. Then wave the flag and recite the poem aloud. Point out the different things on your flag as you recite the poem, for example, the white part, the green part, the crescent and the star.

Read the poem below:

I wish I were a cuckoo bird
Flying up and up
in the cool blue sky.

Flying up and up
Under the shining sun
Looking at the pretty
flowers.

Singing like the cuckoo bird
Coo coo coo
And pecking sweet mangoes.



What do you wish to become? Write about it. Imagine things you would do if your wish came true.



Exercise 1: Vocabulary; Make as many words as you can with the word:

Hospital

Exercise 2: Dictionary Skills: Put the words in alphabetical order.

Exercise 3: Writing: use as many of these words as you can in sentences.

Exercise 4: Look at the pictures and write one sentence about each of them:


